Peter Polner

Professor Cawthon

POLS&204

11 December 2024

Final Extra Credit: Make the Map Make Sense

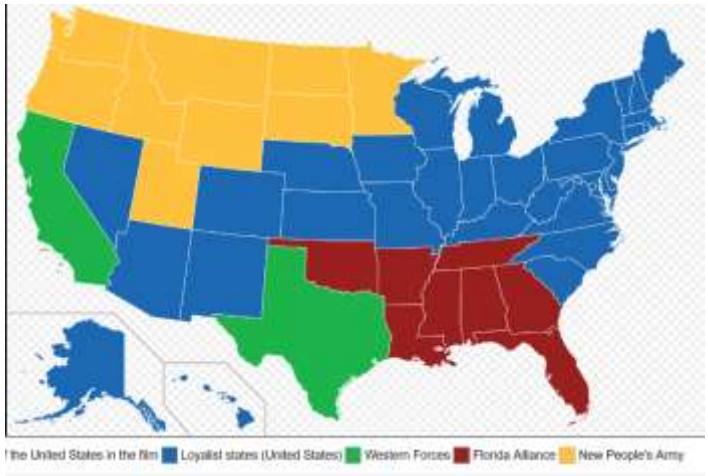


Fig. 1. This map shows the factions which the United States splintered off into from the Alex Garland A24 film *Civil War* (Cawthon). Based on Promotional material for the movie from Instagram ("Map Movie Poster").

From an Outside Perspective the factions found within this map feel strange, first and foremost California and Texas in an alliance, shocking due to their opposing ideologies on the national stage. However, the entire map can make more sense if you place it into a little more socioeconomic and political context.

First, the "Western forces" represented by California and Texas on the map make sense when you consider that both have major metropolitan areas, that make up almost a 1/3 of the U.S. population, with enough agricultural output to sustain itself and even export. Due to the powerhouse roles that both these states play in the U.S. Economy makes their identities very

independent minded, meaning their matchups are even more desired against the rest of the conjoined alliances.

Followed by the “Florida Alliance” which is clearly close to the current and past political alignment of the south. The boundaries show much of the confederate south remaining from the “first” U.S. Civil war, which remain in the south’s current political climate.

This might have you asking about the Carolinas, which are considered southern states, however I believe this builds into the makeup of the “loyalist states”. On the Eastern side the proximity of states to D.C. makes independence movements within major metropolitan areas line New York City hard to arise. Moving westward however including parts of the rust belt, and states like West Virginia, which rely heavily on the government and its programs (they can’t be as self-sufficient as California or Texas); which brings more clarity to the western-most part of the loyalist, obviously trying to combat an overtake by the Western Forces.

Looking at the “New People’s Army” first analysis would lead you towards the independence movement in the northwest the “Cascadia” independence movement, which would fall in line with the people’s army name, but this would crucially leave out eastern states like Minnesota or more rural states like Montana and Wyoming. I believe that this organization came out of Utah, the state that is a crucial bastion for the church of Jesus Christ and latter-day saints, the Mormons, which makes since the largest population of Mormons occurs within Utah and Idaho. A power struggle out of the secession of the south and big states like California and Texas could leave a large space for a religious figure to fill the space.

Works Cited

Cawthon, Clifford. “Final Extra Credit: Make the Map Make Sense” *POLS&204 14233: United States Government > Assignments*. *Bellevue College*, Canvas, 2024, https://bc.instructure.com/courses/2476661/assignments/35037707. Accessed 11 Dec. 2024.

“Civil War Map Movie Poster.” Produced by A24. *Civil War*, directed by Alex Garland, A24, 2024, Promotional Material. *Instagram*, 2 Apr. 2024, https://www.instagram.com/p/C5RVX-3xOOT/?igsh=MTdscG12MW04ZG1icQ==.